

Sri Krishna-chaitanya-charitamrita

"The Nectar of Sri Krishna Chaitanya's Acts" (Murari Gupta's *Kadacha*)

Murari Gupta

Translated from the Sanskrit into English

Translator's Note

Sri Krishna-chaitanya-charitamrita is the Sanskrit poem of Murari Gupta, a fellow-countryman and companion of

Sri Chaitanya and an eyewitness of his life in Navadvipa; tradition calls it Murari Gupta's *Kadacha* ("notes"). It

is the earliest biography of Mahaprabhu, drawn upon by Vrindavana Dasa, Kavikarnapura, Lochana Dasa and Krishnadasa

Kaviraja. The poem is divided into four *prakramas* (parts) and 78 *sargas* (cantos).

Source. The Sanskrit text has been reconstructed from three OCR copies: two scans of the edition of Haridasa

Shastri (Vrindavana) and the edition of Haridasa Dasa (Calcutta, 1945, Bengali script); readings were checked against

metre and grammar. Verse numbering follows Haridasa Shastri's edition. Only Murari Gupta's Sanskrit text has been

translated; the translations and commentaries of the editions were not used. Interpretation follows Srila Bhaktisiddhanta Sarasvati.

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Prakrama One

Prakrama 1, Sarga 1. The Sequence of the Descent

Benediction; the appearance of Vishvambhara; Srivasa bids Murari tell of the Lord; Navadvipa and its devotees; Jagannatha Mishra

1. Glory to Him! His prowess is utterly pure; He shines like gold; His eyes are wide as lotus petals; His shapely arms reach down to His fine knees; and in many ways He dances in the rasa of devotion.
2. He — the son of Jagannatha, Lord and origin of the world, the all-powerful one who takes away the world's distress, protector in the age of Kali and remover of its burden — was born of Shachi, bringing with Him devotion to Himself.
3. Welcomed by the best of the twice-born in the lands of Navadvipa, Hari lived happily at home, a joy to His parents; and the Veda with its six limbs¹
4. He studied while living in His guru's house, devoted to serving him and pure in His vows. And this same Hari, called Vishvambhara, so that the righteous might follow the dharma of the age,
5. enjoined the kirtana of Hari for the sake of man's highest goal, remembering that it is dear beyond measure to Hari. And when He Himself was performing the rite for His ancestors at Gaya, in the land marked by Hari's feet,
6. the mere remembrance of Himself — that treasure — left Him stunned with love, the hair of His body standing on end. Then, at the word of a bodiless voice², He returned to His own home.
7. Surrounded by the foremost of His devotees, the Lord — the crusher of the lions among the Danavas, whose form was filled with ripened love — gave Himself joyfully to the kirtana of Hari and to holy talk of Him.
8. And then, so that thirsting ears might plunge into the glory of Him whose fame is noble — a glory that is nectar to the ears of the virtuous — one whose eyes were brimming with trembling tears of joy took up this splendid, auspicious and true narrative³.
9. A devotee named Srivasa, the sun who makes the lotus of the twice-born race bloom, said to Sri Murari: "Tell here a new and holy account of Hari's life." Accepting his command, Murari openly joined his palms, bowed to him again and again, and himself began to tell the glory of Sriman Chaitanya, which washes away the stain of Kali.
10. Then Murari, the physician's son, reflected: "How shall I tell the auspicious story of Chaitanya, so rich in meaning,
11. which even Vachaspati⁴ himself cannot tell? And yet it is right to carry out a Vaishnava's command — so I have resolved;
12. and my resolve shines ever pure through the treasure of remembering Krishna. A Vaishnava's command is sure to bear fruit — it cannot be otherwise."
13. With these words he began to tell the story, steeped in devotion to Bhagavan — for the sake of dharma, wealth and pleasure, for liberation, and for devotion to Vishnu.
14. I bow to Chaitanya — the unborn, the ancient Hari, four-armed, bearing conch, mace, lotus and disc. His chest is marked with the sign of Shrivatsa, a gem rests on His fair brow, and His garments are fine.
15. For the delight of the virtuous I shall tell something of the stories of Bhagavan. Should some slip occur, to correct it is the task of the greatest souls, those who do good to others: in this they alone

are the measure.

16. In the holy land called Navadvipa, devoted wholly to Vishnu, live brahmanas — saintly, peaceful Vaishnavas of good families,
17. great souls, skilled in rites, every one a master of the meaning of the scriptures; and many other people live there too — physicians, shudras and merchants.
18. All of them are true to their own duties and pure; all live by learning; all have vowed themselves to God — in that place, which is like the abode of Vaikuntha.
19. There shone Srivasa, an intoxicated bee sporting at Hari's lotus feet: wet with the tears of love, his arms flung up⁵, ever eager, he sings of the Lord in the rapture of the highest rasa. There too was Gopinatha⁶, foremost of the twice-born: as soon as the name of Krishna reached his ears, he would weep aloud again and again in his intoxication and dance beyond all measure, his hands quivering to the rhythm.
20. There shone the lord Sri Advaita, the most excellent, the great soul. Radiant as the rising morning sun, he knew how to awaken the wise as the sun awakens lotuses; like the moon born of the ocean of compassion, he was the one embodiment of the peace that cools the burning in people's hearts. Unsurpassed in loving meditation, rich in the fine gift of the art of dance, he was a teacher of the art of the highest rasa.
21. There shone brightly the teacher Chandrashekhara, king of the twice-born⁷, endowed with every virtue: at the name of Krishna the hair of his body stood on end, and he was wet with streaming tears.
22. There, when the sage Haridasa dances, the Lord of the world, out of love for His servant, at once looks on that dance with delight, together with the hosts of gods who roam the sky, and with Mahesha.
23. There flows the river born from Vishnu's foot — swift, and brimming with the waters of compassion; vying with the Yamuna, daughter of the Sun, and with the Sarayu, she has received Hari, shining like gold⁸.
24. There lived Jagannatha — like the moon risen from the ocean of the twice-born race — a teacher of the Vedas, endowed with all virtues, equal to Brihaspati. His mind purified by the mighty yoga of meditation on Krishna's feet, his heart melting with love, he swiftly waxed like the crescent of the new moon.

Thus ends the first sarga, "The Sequence of the Descent," of the first prakrama of the great poem "Sri Chaitanya-charita."

1. The six angas (auxiliary disciplines) of the Veda: phonetics, ritual, grammar, etymology, metrics and astronomy.
2. The "bodiless voice" (asharira vak) is a voice from the sky, heard without a visible speaker.
3. The subject is not named; to judge from the next verse, it is the poet himself, Murari Gupta.
4. Vachaspati ("lord of speech") is Brihaspati, the preceptor of the gods, the model of eloquence.
5. The beginning of the second line of this verse is damaged in the sources; "his arms flung up" is a tentative reading restored by the metre.
6. Gopinatha is a brahmana of Navadvipa; apparently Gopinatha Acharya, who later appears in Nilachala.
7. "King of the twice-born" (dvija-raj) is also a poetic name of the moon — a play on the name Chandrashekhara ("Crowned with the Moon").
8. On the banks of the Yamuna Krishna played, on the banks of the Sarayu (in Ayodhya) Rama; the Ganga at Navadvipa has received Gaura.

Prakrama 1, Sarga 2. Narada's Sorrow

Jagannatha Mishra and Shachi; the birth of Vishvarupa; Damodara Pandita's question; Narada sees the earth gripped by Kali

1. Then his guru, a knower of the truth, honoured him, who had mastered the meaning of all the scriptures, with the title "Shriman Mishra Purandara"¹.
2. One day the illustrious and great-hearted Chakravarti named Nilambara summoned this learned man of noble family, the best of the righteous,
3. and he, the support of his line², gave him his daughter Shachi in marriage. Having won her, Mishra prospered, like Purandara who won Shachi³.
4. He lived at home, and his dharma kept growing — through hospitality, propitiatory rites, purifications, and the fruits of rites both regular and performed for a desired end.
5. In the course of time eight lovely daughters were born to him one after another, but by the will of fate they all died. And Shachi,
6. her heart scorched by a mother's grief, took refuge in Hari within her mind, praying for a son; and the illustrious Mishra performed a sacrifice to the ancestors.
7. After some time he obtained a son like a son of the gods, and Jagannatha rejoiced like a poor man who has found a treasure.
8. The father named the illustrious boy Vishvarupa. In a very short time that great soul learned
9. the Vedas and the science of logic and became renowned: excellent, endowed with true yoga, he was all-knowing, wise, serene, and a benefactor to all.
10. Ever absorbed in meditation on Hari, he never turned his mind to the things of the senses, and was ceaselessly intoxicated with the taste of the rasa of the Srimad-Bhagavatam.
11. As his younger brother the Lord Himself was born, the unborn source of the world — just as Upendra, the younger brother of Indra, was born the son of Kashyapa and Aditi⁴.
12. He Himself made the three worlds devoted to the sankirtana of Hari. He dwelt in the foremost of holy places, called Purushottama;
13. He showed devotion to Hari and taught it to the people; He tasted the sweetness of Sri Vrindavana and gave the people to taste it;
14. and, having delivered the whole world, honoured by the dwellers of Vaikuntha, He joyfully departed for His very own abode, rich in great splendour.
15. Hearing of this wonder, the brahmachari Sri Damodara Pandita⁵, master of his senses and intoxicated with the stories of Sri Chaitanya, said:
16. "Tell the divine and wondrous story that purifies the world: by hearing it people are freed from the round of births and from dreadful sin.
17. Through it the supreme treasures of love for the lotus feet of Sri Krishna arise in all people. So tell us of Hari!
18. For what reason was He, the all-powerful Lord of all, born on earth? What did He, the Lord of the worlds, accomplish here?
19. Be pleased to tell of His auspicious and blessed deeds — to relieve the sufferings of the worlds, and for the love of the very great souls."
20. Hearing the words of the great-hearted pandita, Murari answered with pleasure: "Listen!
21. Well then, O best of the twice-born, I shall tell you as far as I am able — in brief, for not even Bhargava⁶ could tell it in full.

22. Once, in the land called Bharata, Narada — the righteous soul, foremost of the Vaishnavas, of great power, radiant as the full moon,
23. white as the peak of Kailasa, adorned with a fine girdle, clad in a deerskin, a portion of Vishnu, beloved of all people —
24. was roaming the vault of the sky for the good of all, joyfully sounding his Mahati⁷, which sings the name of Hari.
25. 'Where shall I find a Vaishnava? There I shall now make my dwelling,' he thought, and surveyed this earth with his mind.
26. And he saw that Kali, the friend of sin, had soiled the wide earth with filth, and that the earth-cow herself was in the hands of the mlechchhas, drained by cruel taxes⁸.
27. He saw there, too, people beset by sins and diseases, eager to slander others, deceitful, short-lived and wasted;
28. he saw kings skilled in sin, shudras, villainous Yavanas, mlechchhas given to forbidden deeds and robbing their subjects of all they had,
29. and even men learned in scripture — proud, and reviling the saints. Seeing all these people, so many and so various, Narada fell to pondering."

Thus ends the second sarga, "Narada's Sorrow," of the first prakrama of the great poem "Sri Krishna-chaitanya-charita."

1. Purandara ("Destroyer of Strongholds") is a name of Indra; hence the wordplay in v. 3, since Indra's consort is also named Shachi.
2. The epithet kula-kricchada is the same in all the sources, but its meaning is unclear; the translation is conjectural.
3. That is, like Indra, who won his consort Shachi.
4. Upendra is Vishnu as Vamana, born of the sage Kashyapa and Aditi as Indra's younger brother.
5. From this verse the poem is framed as a dialogue: Damodara Pandita asks, and Murari tells.
6. Bhargava is Shukra, the preceptor of the asuras, famed for his wisdom.
7. The Mahati is Narada's vina.
8. A play on words: go means both "earth" and "cow"; kara means both "tax" and "ray" (the earth is parched as if by scorching rays). Mlechchhas and Yavanas are foreigners outside Vedic dharma; the Muslim rulers of Bengal are meant.

Prakrama 1, Sarga 3. Narada's Inquiry

Narada goes to Vaikuntha; the vision of Vaikuntha and of Krishna; Narada pleads for the world perishing in Kali; the Lord agrees to descend

1. "'In the first twilight of Kali¹ this earth has sunk (into sin). For all who are scorched by sin, the name of Hari is the healing elixir;
2. it surely delivers everyone except those who hate the Vaishnavas — the self-conceited and the revilers of Vaishnavas.
3. But those dull-witted ones who would revile the name of Krishna and His forms, calling them non-eternal² — for them there is only hell.
4. What remedy can there be for this?' Having pondered thus, the sage, pure of mind, a treasury of compassion, went to the supreme abode called Vaikuntha.
5. And the sage beheld Vaikuntha, the undivided abode sung by the three Vedas, which by its own radiance has scattered all the dust (of rajas) from every quarter; and he attained a state beyond the gunas.

6. There swarms of bees sing Hari's fame among rows of lotuses; it is adorned with ponds lovely with jewelled banks and fragrant with hanging creepers.
7. There are ruby houses with turrets adorned with strings of pearls from the heads of lordly elephants³; there are trees that bear fruit in every season; there birds fill the air with song, and paths of moonstone abound.
8. There he saw the Unborn, the Primeval One, whom Shri attends: His locks are lit by the radiance of a gleaming crown, His eyes outshine blooming celestial lotuses, and His fair, shining face is worshipped by the moon itself;
9. great gleaming earrings grace His cheeks, His neck is fine as a conch, His garments shine like gold — Krishna, whose four arms are like door-bars: He was like a blue mountain peak with wish-fulfilling trees.
10. He was resplendent with golden armlets and other ornaments, with strings of pearls and fine golden cords; on His hips shone a cloth bound with a net of little bells, and His feet were lovely lotuses.
11. Inhaling the enchanting fragrance of His lotus feet, the sage, with tears of joy and his hair standing on end, at once fell to the ground near Krishna, stretched out like a rod, as if senseless.
12. Then the grateful Lord at once stretched out His hand, the radiance of its nails mingling with the gleam of jewelled rings, joyfully touched the sage's head and, with a gentle smile on His face, spoke enchantingly:
13. 'Rise, O son of the Self-born⁴, O sage, O great soul! Whatever you tell Me today, that I shall do for you. For My time has come of itself — the time when, in the ages, the righteous must practise dharma.'
14. Then Hari, wholly devoted to the greatest souls, raised up the best of the great rishis and at once showed him to a seat; and at Hari's bidding the sage sat down.
15. Then Bhagavan asked: 'O sage, why have you come here to Me? What is your wish? Though I am complete, let Me do your task, O holy one: the great exert themselves for the good of others.'
16. Such were the nectarean words of Krishna, the ocean of the nectar of mercy, resonant as a rain-laden cloud. And under Hari's glance, full of smiles, the sage said: 'I bow to You! Protect the suffering worlds!'
17. Now, O mighty Lord, the earth is wasting away in distress under the weight of people laden with floods of sin. All the people, bitten by the time of Kali, delight in sin and have abandoned talk of You.
18. Protect them, O Master: apart from You they have no other protector from hell, no other good refuge. Consider this and act, O Lord of all worlds: You Yourself are the good refuge, O Lord, and no other.'
19. Having heard these words of the sage, Hari, though He knew all, said: 'What shall I do? By what means can peace come about? Tell Me.' And the son of the Self-born spoke to Him again:
20. 'Descend Yourself, cooling as a hundred moons, into a good family of the brahmana race, of the Vatsya line⁵; win renown as "the son of Jagannatha," and bring welfare to the earth.
21. What You did, O Bhagavan, in the forms of Rama and others — the slaying of sinful Rakshasas and Danavas and the like — is not to be done here: purify the minds of men.
22. "If I slay those who have fallen into the demoniac state, where then will the world be?" — resolving thus in Your own mind, make Your glory known, and may the people be happy.

23. And there too, together with Rudra, the foremost of sages will descend to help You⁶. 'So be it,' Hari said to the divine rishi; and he, bowing, at once departed joyfully."

Thus ends the third sarga, "Narada's Inquiry," of the first prakrama of the great poem "Sri Krishna-chaitanya-charita."

1. The "twilight" (sandhya) is the opening period of a yuga; the Kali age has only just begun.
 2. The Lord's name and form are eternal and not material; to call them non-eternal is an offence.
 3. According to poetic convention, pearls form in the heads of lordly elephants.
 4. Narada is the son of Brahma, the Self-born (Svayambhu).
 5. Vatsya is the brahmana clan (gotra) to which Jagannatha Mishra belonged.
 6. Which gods and sages descended together with the Lord is told in the next sarga.
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Prakrama 1, Sarga 4. On the Descents

The Lord's companions as portions of the Lord, of gods and of sages; the story of Haridasa; the two kinds of avatara: the avatars of the ages and the avatars for a particular purpose

1. Having heard all this, Sri Damodara Pandita, greatly pleased, said: "Tell us, then, the story of Nrihari¹.
2. Who came down to the earth in these descents? And of how many kinds are the descents? Tell me of them in order."
3. Hearing these words of the foremost of the twice-born, Sri Murari answered with great affection and respect: "Listen!
4. Now I shall tell you of something else — of the descent of Hari's own portions, the devotees who are forms of the Lord, though renowned as pure devotees.
5. First was born the best of the twice-born, the master Sri Madhava Puri. A portion of the Lord, dividing in two, appeared both as him and as Advaita Acharya, rich in virtues².
6. The disciple of them both was the divine Chandrashekhara, a portion of the Moon; of great fame, he is renowned on earth as Acharyaratna.
7. Sriman Srivasa Pandita was born as a portion of Sri Narada, and Sri Mukunda of the Vaidya (physician) caste, the fine singer, as a portion of a Gandharva.
8. Sriman Sri Haridasa was a portion of a sage. Hear how this was once told by a brahmana bitten by a snake³.
9. Long ago in Dravida, in a Vaishnava holy place, there lived an illustrious sage named Rama, the best of sages, a great ascetic, who loved his son dearly.
10. His son washed some tulasi and placed it in a clean vessel, but it fell to the ground, and without washing it again
11. he gave it to his father, and the father, the great sage named Sri Rama, offered it to Bhagavan. For that reason he was born in a family of Yavanas (Muslims).
12. He is righteous, wise, peaceful and versed in all knowledge; moreover, he is a portion of Brahma⁴, and therefore the illustrious Haridasa is beyond doubt a true devotee.
13. The Avadhuta Nityananda, the greatest of all, of mighty power, was born as a portion of Baladeva; he is the great yogi, the Lord Himself.
14. I do not venture to describe his family, character and deeds: even Brihaspati himself, in a hundred years,

15. could not tell of them — what then of others, of petty creatures like us! He is the second form of Sri Krishna, dear to Gauranga as life itself.
16. And many others — hundreds of gods and eminent sages — were born on earth as portions; I do not venture to count them.
17. Next: it is declared that the descents of the Purusha are of two kinds. The first is the avatara of the age (yuga-avatara); the other appears for a particular task.
18. Those are called avataras of the ages who appear in age after age and establish dharma. Hear of them in order.
19. In the Satya age meditation alone leads a man to the goal. For this purpose the White One descended, four-armed, with matted locks;
20. like a thousand moons, a sage always absorbed in meditation, He became the teacher of meditation for all living beings.
21. In the Treta age the one dharma that achieves every aim is sacrifice. Then Yajna Himself was born, with the sacrificial ladles and the other implements.
22. Together with brahmanas who performed sacrifice, He, Janardana, the enjoyer of sacrifice, the Victorious One, Himself performed sacrifice and taught it to all the people.
23. In the Dvapara age worship is ordained for attaining the goal of life. Knowing this, Vishnu Himself appeared in the form of Prithu⁵.
24. Righteous, He Himself performed worship and instructed the people in it, and the minds of all turned to worship.
25. But in Kali the highest good is kirtana: the dharma that benefits all, full of every power, directly bestowing the highest bliss.
26. Having resolved thus in His mind, Sri Chaitanya Mahaprabhu Himself was born on earth, bringing happiness to the saintly.
27. Full of joy, He Himself sang kirtana and moved others to sing it. These are the avataras of the ages. Hear now of the others — those who descend for a particular task.
28. As the Fish — the rescue of the Vedas; as the Tortoise — the bearing of Mount Mandara; as the Boar — the lifting up of the earth; as Narasimha — the tearing apart (of Hiranyakashipu);
29. as Vamana He took for Himself the sovereignty of the worlds from the king of the Danavas; and Bhargava⁶ conquered the earth, defeating the arrogant kings,
30. and Vishnu, the sole deliverer of the world, gave that earth to a brahmana. As Sri Rama He slew Ravana, and the world was filled with His glory.
31. And in the descent of Srīman Krishna, Hari Himself, endowed with all powers, removed the burden of the earth.
32. As the Buddha the Supreme Bhagavan bewildered (people) regarding the Vedas, and in the form of Kalki He destroyed the mlechchas.
33. Such are the many deeds of the many-formed Nrihari; these avataras who descend for a particular task have been described by the great rishis."

Thus ends the fourth sarga, "On the Descents" (Avataranukarana), of the first prakrama of the great poem "Sri Krishna-chaitanya-charitamrita."

1. Nrihari ("Man-Hari") is usually a name of Nrisimha; here, as in v. 33, it names the Lord in general.

2. The sense is that a single portion of the Lord appeared in two ways — as Madhavendra Puri and as Advaita Acharya.

3. The brahmana's account itself is not given in the poem; Murari relates only its substance (vv. 9–11). Possibly "Bitten by a Snake" (Nagadashta) is the brahmana's name.
 4. According to tradition, Haridasa is a portion of Brahma, who appeared as a devotee to atone for an offence.
 5. The avatara of the Dvapara age is usually named otherwise; here Murari Gupta names Prithu, the king who first established the order of worship.
 6. Bhargava is Parashurama, the descendant of Bhrigu.
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Prakrama 1, Sarga 5. The Appearance of Sri Chaitanya

Shachi bears in her womb a portion of Hari; the hymn of the gods to Shachi; the Lord's birth on the full-moon night of Phalguna during a lunar eclipse; the prediction of Nilambara Chakravarti; the rites after the birth

1. "Hear attentively, O brahmana, the new story of the descent of Chaitanya — the all-powerful Lord of the world, the ocean of compassion.
2. When the best of the divine sages¹ had gone to his own hermitage, the Supreme Bhagavan Achyuta entered the mind of Jagannatha, the brahmana sage.
3. In due time the chaste wife received the great splendour he had placed in her. Thus the virtuous Shachi, devoted to her husband,
4. auspicious, conceived a child — a portion of Hari — as the Ganga once received the seed of Shambhu²; and her radiance waxed like the moon in the bright fortnight.
5. Seeing her beauty and her glow like molten gold, Jagannatha, graced with good fortune, rejoiced with all his heart.
6. Then, seeing her so, Brahma and the other gods, the Gandharvas, the immortals and the dwellers of the sky together with Indra
7. joined their palms in joy; with tears in their voices and eyes, their heads bowed in obeisance, they all joyfully sang her praise:
8. 'We bow to you who ever bear Him in your womb! You are Aditi, the mother of Hari; you bear in your womb the radiance of moon, sun and fire, you bear pure being in your womb; you are steadfastness and forbearance;
9. you bear freedom from malice in your womb; you are perfection; you bear in your womb the Veda — Hari Himself. You are Devaki, Rohini and Yashoda — in every guise the source of being³.
10. You bear in your womb Him who will spread the holiest of sacrifices — kirtana, whose fruit no (ordinary) sacrifice can attain.
11. Not even millions of sacrifices could give the joy that arises in such as us from half a moment of hearing the kirtana of Nrihari.
12. Oh! Great was the nectar of immortality that Hari Himself once gave after churning the ocean⁴ — yet a sweetness a million times greater
13. we taste here, hearing the glory of Sri Hari: for the sake of the kirtana of Hari the mind counts even liberation as nothing.'
14. Having spoken thus, the gods with Indra bowed to her and, placing Brahma at their head, departed, singing the glory of Sri Hari,
15. to their own city. Overjoyed that a portion of the Lord of Shri had been born on earth, they praised the good fortune of (the age of) Kali and danced, overwhelmed with love.

16. And then at midnight, in the auspicious month of Phalgunā, when the moon, the lord of the night, was full, at an hour rich in every excellence and fanned by a pure breeze,
17. when the minds of the gods and the saints were serene and the waters of the heavenly river cool and pure — Hari Himself was born.
18. The son he had obtained was golden; His eyes were like blossoming lotuses, His face like the shining full moon, and by His own splendour He drove the darkness from every quarter.
19. And Sri Jagannatha Mishra Purandara, like a poor man who has found the padma treasure⁵, could not reach the further shore of his ocean of joy, and his voice kept faltering with love.
20. At the hour of His birth Rahu swallowed the moon entirely: defeated by the lotus face of Krishna, the moon, as if out of shame, hid in the mouth of the enemy of the gods⁶.
21. At that holy hour the people sang the kirtana of Narahari and offered worship, and then, keeping themselves pure, they bathed in the waters of the Jahnavi, gave gifts and performed the rite of cleansing from sin.
22. The hosts of gods with Mahendra, led by the Lotus-born and Mahesha, rejoiced; the apsaras gave themselves to dancing, and the leaders (of the Gandharvas) rained down flowers.
23. Delighted by His birth, Nilambara Chakravarti, the knower of all scriptures, hurried to the home of his son-in-law.
24. The wise man, who knew (from the stars) the hour of his grandson's birth, called Jagannatha and, addressing Shachi, spoke these words:
25. 'Oh! This lion among men is born when Brihaspati (Jupiter) stands in exaltation⁷. He will be the eternal protector of the whole world;
26. of noble character, the refuge of all dharmas, the best of sannyasis, He will gladden all beings like the full moon pouring nectar.
27. He will forever deliver both lineages — his father's and his mother's.' When the brahmana had spoken thus, all the people rejoiced.
28. Hearing these words of her father, the mother was filled with great joy, and the Vatsya⁸ held a great festival — the jatakarma, the birth rite of his son.
29. He gave the brahmanas betel, sandal paste, garlands and fragrances, and in due order performed the auspicious rites beginning with the utthana, the rite of "rising"⁹."

Thus ends the fifth sarga, "The Appearance of Sri Chaitanya" (Sri Chaitanya-avirbhava), of the great poem "Sri Krishna-chaitanya-charitamrita."

1. Narada, at whose entreaty the Lord agreed to descend (Sarga 1.03).
2. An allusion to the birth of Skanda: the seed of Shiva (Shambhu) was received by the Ganga.
3. The reading of the last word of the verse is uncertain; the translation is tentative.
4. The churning of the Milk Ocean by the gods and asuras, from which the nectar of immortality (amrita) was obtained.
5. Padma is one of the nine treasures (nidhi) of Kubera.
6. The Lord's birth coincided with a lunar eclipse; Rahu is the demon, "the enemy of the gods," who swallows the moon.
7. The "exalted position" (uccha) of a planet in astrology is the sign of its greatest strength.
8. The Vatsya is Jagannatha Mishra, of the Vatsya clan.
9. Probably the rite marking the end of the lying-in period; another understanding is possible — the child's first standing up.

Prakrama 1, Sarga 6. The Description of the Pastimes from Birth among the Childhood Plays

Vishvambhara's infancy: the naming, His form, childhood plays; the wandering brahmana; the broken pots; the teaching on pure and impure; the brick thrown at His mother; the two coconuts; the sound of ankle bells

1. Some time passed, and the husband and wife, watching their sweetly babbling infant crawl about on His knees, were filled with great joy.
2. On His smiling face, like a red lotus, shone the rays of "the king of the twice-born"¹, dispelling the darkness in the minds of the saints.
3. "He has sustained the universe from of old," thought the father, and he himself gave Him the most beautiful name Sriman Vishvambhara².
4. Hari's body gleamed like molten gold, His eyes were wide as shining lotuses; clad only in the wind, He wore a silver necklace and a garland in His curls.
5. His face was like the full moon, His babble sweet as nectar; bracelets on His wrists and armlets on His arms adorned the charming child.
6. Pure, His palms and soles red as a lotus or ground vermillion, He grew day by day, waxing digit by digit like the moon in the bright fortnight.
7. In time the infant of boundless radiance began to walk, and treading with His red feet He soothed the earth's burning, born of separation (from Him)³.
8. Janardana ate the food of a brahmana who wandered among the holy places, and so reminded him of the wonder in the house of Nanda⁴.
9. He played with the boys of His age, (swinging) shoots of trees, and the children, struck by them, all romped joyfully before Him.
10. Hari, a child by His own maya, played like a monkey: standing on one foot, He would touch another boy's knee with His knee.
11. Once, seeing His mother angrily about to seize Him, He grew angry Himself and smashed the pots.
12. He whom Yashoda once bound with cattle ropes for a broken pot⁵ — Him Shachi now feared: looking at His face, she trembled.
13. Then He sat down in an impure place, on a heap of discarded clay pots piled one upon another, and laughed in front of His mother.
14. Seeing this, Shachi said: "Child, come away from that loathsome place! Bathe again, be clean, and climb onto my lap."
15. At these words Bhagavan, the knower of all truths, wholly imbued with the mood of Dattatreya⁶, who completes (the knowledge) of the all-knowing, answered her:
16. "Listen: pure and impure are mere notions of the mind. For the world is (only) earth, water, air, fire, ether and mind; and here shines only the one Hari, the ocean of compassion, whose lotus feet are non-dual and prior to all the outspread manifestation. Know that there is nothing else.
17. Therefore I am pure and in no way impure. Know this, mother, and harbour no other doubt here."
18. When her son had spoken thus, she hastily took Him by the hand, led Him (to the river) and bathed Him in the clear waters of the heavenly river.

19. After some time Shachi again saw her son seated on a heap of thrown-away clay pots and scolded Him:
20. "Foolish one! Why do you sit in an impure, forbidden place?" Hearing these words of His mother, filled with anger,
21. Sriman Vishvambhara said: "Foolish woman! There is nothing impure anywhere. I told you this before — so why do you reproach Me?"
22. With these words He angrily threw a brick at her face. Stricken by the blow, she fainted and fell.
23. Then all the women gathered and sprinkled her with cool water. And then Hari, who acts in human ways, came there
24. and at once burst into tears Himself: "Mother, mother!" — and laid on her face His beautiful hand, which takes away every sorrow.
25. Shachi came to herself at once, took her son onto her lap and, beside herself with love for him, rejoiced with all her heart.
26. Then a merry woman, fond of a joke, said to the Teacher of the world: "Go and fetch two coconuts for your mother,
27. bring them and give them to her — then she will be well. If not, she will die — and what will you do then?"
28. Hearing her words, He (slipped down) from His mother's lap⁷, went out, brought and gave two coconuts.
29. Hari brought a pair of coconuts whose stalks still glistened with sap, as if they had just fallen. The astonished women asked: "Where did you get this fruit?"
30. Then the great-hearted (boy), the banner of the Vatsa clan⁸, silenced them all with a fierce "hum!" and turned His smiling lotus face to His mother.
31. Now hear more of the wonderful deeds of the Great Soul — the Supreme Self, the Lord of maya: excellent deeds, beyond all that is worldly.
32. One night Shachi, having fallen asleep, noticed that the house seemed full of people; alarmed, she took her son, who lay on her lap,
33. and in fear hastily sent Sriman Vishvambhara Hari to her husband's room; and on the way the gods worshipped Him⁹.
34. As the son walked there, the jingling of ankle bells came again and again from His bare feet. Hearing it, the alarmed Vatsya asked Shachi, and Shachi the Vatsya: "What is this? Where does this sound come from?"
35. When the son came near, the brahmana saw in great amazement that his son's lotus feet were quite bare. "Then where did the sweet jingling of ankle bells come from?" (he wondered) — and, embracing his son, he was filled with joy.

Thus ends the sixth sarga, "The Description of the Pastimes from Birth among the Childhood Plays" (Balya-krida: janmadi-lila-varnana), of the first prakrama of the great poem "Sri Krishna-chaitanya-charitamrita."

1. "The king of the twice-born" (dvijaraja) is the moon; but "the twice-born" (dvija) are also the teeth: a play on words — the shining of His teeth in His smile.

2. Vishvambhara means "He who sustains the universe."

3. The earth, according to tradition, suffered in separation from Krishna's feet after His departure.

4. The story of the pilgrim brahmana whose food, offered to the Lord, was eaten by the infant Nimai; so too the infant Krishna once ate the food of a wandering brahmana in the house of Nanda.
 5. An allusion to the Bhagavata Purana (10.9): Yashoda bound the child Krishna when He broke the pot of curd.
 6. Dattatreya is an incarnation of the Lord, an avadhuta who made no distinction between pure and impure.
 7. The end of the line is corrupt in the sources; the reading is tentative.
 8. The Vatsa clan (gotra) is the clan of Jagannatha Mishra (cf. "the Vatsya").
 9. The people Shachi saw in the house were evidently the gods, come to worship the Lord.
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Prakrama 1, Sarga 7. The Childhood Plays

The story of Vishvarupa: his sannyasa and the parents' blessing; Vishvambhara's promise to serve his parents; His pranks and the dream of Jagannatha Mishra; Vishvambhara asks His mother not to eat on Ekadashi; the question of Damodara

1. Having heard this, and blissful in meditation on Hari's lotus feet, Damodara asked to hear the holy story of Hari's elder brother:
2. "Tell me truly the great and renowned story of Vishvarupa." Hearing this, (Murari) replied: "Listen, O brahmana, and I shall tell you."
3. With these words the physician¹ began the heart-charming, auspicious and purifying story of Vishvarupa, the portion of Baladeva.
4. Sriman Sri Vishvarupa, a treasury of every virtue, utterly pure, became an acharya at sixteen by hearing of the Self and reflecting upon it. Of powerful intellect, a devotee full of love, all-knowing, he was ever joyful, his heart clinging to the feet of Narahari; peaceful and content, unattached to the world, he knew the Vedas and knew rasa.
5. In private the father was considering a suitable bride for his son; but the brahmana's son himself came to know all that he was pondering in his heart.
6. Learning thus all his father's hidden intentions, the forbearing Vishvarupa left home, crossed the heavenly river and took sannyasa, which others cannot attain.
7. When he heard of this, the father was overwhelmed, and the virtuous mother wept bitterly. But then both, wishing their son well, said: "May our son remain true to the dharma of sannyasa!"
8. Having given their son this blessing, both kept their fortitude like sages; casting off grief, they took their son — the Lord of the world — onto their laps and at once were filled with joy.
9. Then Hari said: "Father, My brother has left you and gone far away. It is I who will serve you and mother — and may you always be happy."
10. Hearing such words from their son — weighty, deep, charming and full of meaning — the mother and father embraced Him and, with tears of joy in their eyes, were filled with delight.
11. Their limbs were sated with the sweetness of His touch; bathed in tears, they knew nothing else — as accomplished yogis, absorbed in their own yoga, see neither this world nor the next.
12. He studied, serving His father with all His heart, yet He was also caught up in play among a band of boys: romping with His companions, grey with dust, even when hungry He forgot all about food.
13. Once, seeing his son so wilful, the father, wishing Him well, scolded Him: "You have thrown aside your lessons and everything else, and you play with the boys though you are hungry!"
14. Then at night, toward dawn, the foremost of the best brahmanas appeared to him in a dream and said: "Do you not value your son? Or are you like a beast that knows nothing of the worth of a touchstone?"

15. Deck a beast's body in jewelled silks — will it not chew those silks?"² Mishra fearlessly replied:
"Even if my son is Narayana Himself,
16. still it is my duty to punish Him." To this the brahmana said: "Rightly spoken." With these words the
foremost of brahmanas departed, and the Vatsya, waking, told (of the dream).
17. Hearing of the dream, the people rejoiced and joyfully saw in Vishvambhara, the best of the best, the
fulfilment of their hopes; but the father considered Him his own son, and the mother was content.
18. Once, when He was at home, His body, red as the rays of the rising sun, blazed with its own light,
and He said: "Mother, do as I tell you."
19. Seeing her son blazing with His own light, the frightened and astonished mother said: "Child,
whatever you say I shall do; tell me yourself what is on your mind."
20. Hearing these words, sweet as nectar, He said to her: "Mother, on the day of Hari you must not
eat."³ Hearing her son, she gladly agreed: "So be it."
21. Then, having eaten the betel nut and other things that a certain brahmana had offered (to the Lord),
He spoke to her again: "I am going. Guard the body of your son, which for half a moment will lie
motionless."
22. So saying, He suddenly rose and fell to the ground like a stick. Thinking that Vishvambhara had left
her, the mother, in deep grief,
23. bathed Him with the waters of the Ganga, which are like nectar. Then He awoke, recovered and
lived happily again,
24. shining with His natural radiance. Hearing of this, the astonished Jagannatha said: "We do not
understand this divine maya."
25. Hearing this wondrous story, the brahmana Damodara said: "What is this you have told, good
friend? Krishna Himself, the teacher of the world,
26. was born (here) — how then could He say to His mother, 'I am going; guard your son, good lady'?
About this I have a great doubt.
27. Is this the maya of the Lord of the world? Please explain it — for the deeds of Hari are done for the
good of the world."

Thus ends the seventh sarga, "The Childhood Plays" (Balya-krida), of the first prakrama of the great poem "Sri Krishna-chaitanya-charitamrita."

1. Murari Gupta was a physician (vaidya) by caste and occupation.
2. The sense: you do not value your son, as a beast knows the worth neither of the touchstone nor of precious silk.
3. The lunar day of Hari is Ekadashi, the eleventh day of the lunar fortnight, a fast day.

Prakrama 1, Sarga 8. The Passing of Jagannatha Mishra

Murari's answer: the Lord enters the devotee's heart, and the devotee takes on His form (the examples of Prahlada, the gopis and Narada); Vishvambhara's studies; the illness and passing of Jagannatha Mishra on the bank of the Ganga; the funeral rites

1. Having heard him, (Murari) thought and reflected, bowed to Hari and spoke again: "Listen with all
your attention.
2. When a person meditates on Bhagavan, sings His kirtana and hears (of Him), Hari enters the heart of
that great soul.

3. And then he imitates Him: forgetting his own body and all the rest, he constantly bears within him His splendour and His might.
4. So it is for a time; and then he returns to outer consciousness and does his ordinary acts — as once Prahlada did:
5. in the ocean he became identified (with the Lord), and on the shore the remembrance of his body returned¹. So indeed the virtuous gopis too at times experience such identification².
6. The Lord did this to teach the world a lesson: for a devotee of Krishna there can be such identity of form (with Him).
7. And so that people here should not be bewildered, He taught: the devotee's body is truly the very self of Bhagavan; of this there is no doubt.
8. Krishna, having slain Keshi, showed Narada His glory and His power; and then the best of sages
9. fell to the ground like a stick. And a Vaishnava who goes to the city of Mathura obtains at that place a hundredfold greater reward³.
10. So too Rama, the source of the world, showed His universal form to Shiva, and then again performed human deeds⁴.
11. Now, O brahmana, hear further the auspicious story of Chaitanya: whoever hears it with faith, though mortal, is freed from the bondage of worldly existence.
12. Living in the house of His teacher, the Victorious One studied all the Vedas, and then He Himself, the husband of Sarasvati⁵, taught students.
13. His father too, greatly fortunate, happily studied the Vedanta and other scriptures. And when Jagannatha, the bull among brahmanas, had returned (home),
14. by the will of fate a life-taking fever came upon him. Seeing His father in such a state, Hari Himself, together with His mother,
15. went to the bank of the Jahnavi — the beautiful Lord Vishvambhara, surrounded by His devotees absorbed in the kirtana of Hari.
16. Then Hari embraced both His father's feet and said in a faltering voice: 'Father, My master! Where are you going, leaving Me so soon?'
17. He lovingly drank in with his ears the nectar of his son's words and replied: 'I have entrusted You wholly to the feet of Raghunatha.'⁶
18. By day, when the host of the best gods with Mahendra had appeared in the sky and the people were absorbed in the sankirtana of Hari, the best of brahmanas, standing in the waters of the heavenly river,
19. left his body, mounted the chariot of the heaven-dwellers and went to the abode of Hari. Though the body of that great soul is eternally perfect, he (showed death) at his own will, so that his conduct might serve the good of the world.
20. Then Shachi, utterly broken by grief, lamented her husband who had attained perfection; surrounded by a crowd of women, she fell at the feet of her lord and cried out like an osprey.
21. As the ocean of mercy wept again and again for His father, streams of tears fell from His eyes; leaving on His chest a trace like a necklace of elephant-pearls⁷, they shone.
22. Then, consoled by His relatives, the Lord, full of grief, performed together with the brahmanas all the holy rites fitting for the end of life, according to the injunctions.

23. As if downcast, loving His father, He performed with the accumulated wealth the sacrifice to the ancestors, and then in due order the holy rite of honouring the brahmanas, presenting them with land and other gifts⁸.

24. Whoever tirelessly tells thus of the departure to heaven of the Lord's father will attain the heavenly river and, swiftly casting off impurity, will go to the abode of Hari."

Thus ends the eighth sarga, "The Passing of Jagannatha Mishra" (Jagannatha-mishra-samsiddhi), of the first prakrama of the great poem "Sri Krishna-chaitanya-charitamrita."

1. Prahlada, thrown into the ocean at Hiranyakashipu's command, became absorbed in meditation on the Lord and felt himself one with Him; on the shore he again became aware of his body.
 2. The gopis, in separation from Krishna, imitated His pastimes, identifying themselves with Him.
 3. The place where the demon Keshi was slain in Vrindavana is revered as holy (Keshi-ghat).
 4. Rama is Ramachandra, the avatara of Vishnu; Shiva is His great worshipper.
 5. The husband of Sarasvati (the goddess of learning) — the Lord as master of all knowledge.
 6. Raghunatha ("Lord of the Raghus") is Ramachandra.
 7. By poetic convention, pearls are born in the foreheads of elephants.
 8. The sense of the word "dharadibhajanaih" is unclear; the translation is tentative.
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Prakrama 1, Sarga 9. The Adhivasa before the Marriage to Lakshmi

Vishvambhara studies under the scholars of Navadvipa; He meets Vallabhacharya's daughter on her way to the Ganga; Vanamali Acharya's proposal: Shachi's refusal and consent; Vallabhacharya's consent; preparations for the wedding and the adhivasa rite

1. Then the glorious Lord continued His studies — under Sri Vishnu Pandita, under Sudarshana Pandita and under Sri Gangadasa Pandita.
2. He Himself bestowed knowledge on brahmanas; and from those who were the greatest of scholars He received knowledge, for their own great benefit.
3. For the instruction of the world, He whose human form is assumed by His own maya studied under the scholars and the venerable Sudarshana;
4. and the knower of rasas, His face lit with a smile, would jest with His brahmana fellow students in the dialect of Vanga¹, laughing with them as they laughed in return.
5. Some time passed, and He went, eager and delighted, to the house of Vanamali Acharya, who was devoted to Him, to see him².
6. Having taken leave of the Acharya, Hari was walking back when on the road He saw the daughter of Vallabhacharya, surrounded by her friends.
7. The lovely-faced girl was on her way to bathe in the waters of the Jahnavi. Seeing her so, and knowing in His heart why she had taken birth³,
8. the glorious Lord Vishvambhara, who delighted in the taste of learning, returned with His companions to His own home.
9. The next day Vanamali Acharya, the best of brahmanas, came there again — to the house of Sri Hari — and, bowing to Shachi, addressed her with sweet words:
10. "If you wish to see your son, the glorious Vishvambhara, married, choose for Him as His bride the daughter of the excellent Vallabhacharya — a maiden like a daughter of the gods."
11. Hearing this, Shachi said: "My little son is still a boy, and He has lost His father. Let Him study — that is what we must see to."

12. Having heard her, the Acharya went away not very glad at heart. And there, on the road, he saw Krishna, radiant with joy.
13. At once Bhagavan bowed to him, embraced him warmly and asked him sweetly: "Where are you going today, sir?"
14. He replied: "I have been to see Your mother's feet and proposed to her that You be married. But she
15. gave no credence to it, and so I go away downcast." When he had said this, Hari gave no reply; He only laughed and went on His way.
16. Coming home, He said to His mother: "What did you say to the Acharya? He is walking along the road so sad.
17. Why did you not please him with kind words, mother?" Understanding this wish of her son, the good Shachi at once sent a trusted person again
18. to bring the Acharya back quickly. The Acharya came at once, bowed and said:
19. "For what purpose, mistress, has your ladyship summoned me? Let her tell me. I was overjoyed to hear your call, and here I am before you."
20. Then Shachi said to him: "What you proposed about the marriage — please carry it out.
21. You are a friend and dearly love my son; you yourself proposed it before out of affection — what more need I say to you?"
22. Having heard her, the Acharya bowed and replied: "Mistress, your word I always carry out, bearing it on my head."
23. So saying, he set out for the place where Vallabha, the best of Mishras, lived. Vallabha rose hastily to meet him,
24. himself brought a seat and offered it as custom prescribes; then he humbly asked Vanamali Acharya:
25. "Has kindness to me alone brought you here, or is there some business? Then command me."
26. At this the Acharya said: "Hear what I have to say. The son of Mishra Purandara, Sri Vishvambhara Pandita,
27. the abode of every virtue — He is the one fit to be your daughter's husband. And so I tell you now: give Him your fair daughter."
28. Having heard him, the Mishra considered the matter and said: "Listen: if good fortune wills it, this will come to pass.
29. But I am poor and can give nothing; only the girl herself can I give. Decide, then, what is to be done.
30. If Bhagavan Hari is pleased with me and with my daughter — only then will the best of scholars become my son-in-law.
31. As a pearl is joined to a gem only by a thread, so their union will come about only through your goodness⁴."
32. Greatly pleased at these words, the Acharya replied respectfully: "Thanks to your humility and affection, all will turn out well."
33. So saying, the Acharya returned and told Shachi everything, blissful with joy at Gaurachandra's wedding.
34. When she had learned all this, Shachi said to her son: "The time has come, my child: now perform the marriage rite."

35. Having heard His mother's words, Hari reflected in His mind and, honouring her command, quickly gathered all that was needed.
36. Then came the auspicious time of the wedding — the abode of every good quality, bringing blessing to all. Mridangas and panava drums were beaten,
37. the chanting of the Vedas rose from the great assembly of brahmanas, all the quarters were adorned with rows of lamps, flags and the like,
38. and everything was fragrant with the incense of deodar, aguru, ushira, sandal and other scents — and the best of brahmanas performed for Hari the pre-wedding rite of adhivasa⁵.

Thus ends the ninth sarga, "The Adhivasa before the Marriage to Sri Lakshmi" (Shri-lakshmy-udvahe adhivasa-prasanga), of the first prakrama of the great poem "Sri Krishna-chaitanya-charitamrita."

1. Vanga is the eastern part of Bengal; the family of Jagannatha Mishra came from there (from Shrihatta).
2. Vanamali Acharya, a brahmana of Navadvipa, took on the role of matchmaker.
3. Vallabhacharya's daughter is Lakshmi, Lakshmi herself, who appeared in order to become the Lord's consort.
4. A play on words: guna means both "thread" and "virtue."
5. The adhivasa is a rite of consecration on the eve of a wedding or other festival: the bridegroom is anointed with sandal paste, adorned with flowers and surrounded with incense.

Prakrama 1, Sarga 10. The Wedding

The adhivasa and the nandimukha shraddha; Vishvambhara's tears for His father and His consolation; the wedding procession to Vallabhacharya's house; the giving away of the bride; the Lord's return home with Lakshmi

1. Then again and again He gave the brahmanas betel nuts, fragrant garlands and perfumes with sandal of incomparable fragrance; and all the people rejoiced and sang for joy.
2. Vallabha too arrived — with auspicious brahmanas, with men, with the chaste wives of brahmanas and others — honoured his son-in-law with perfumes and fragrant garlands, and performed for Him the auspicious adhivasa.
3. In the morning, when the sun had risen clear and red, Hari Himself duly performed His bath, worshipped the ancestors, the gods and the rest, and then together with the brahmanas performed the nandimukha shraddha¹.
4. And the great festival swelled: the lovely chanting of the Yajur Veda rose from the brahmanas, mridangas, bheris, patahas and other drums resounded, and bright, auspicious cries rang out from the lotus mouths of lovely women².
5. Shachi joyfully honoured the women of the family and all the kinsfolk who had gathered, and said: "What can I do, bereft of my husband? Here everything must be done by such as you yourselves."
6. Hearing these sorrowful words from His mother, He longed for His father and His heart burned; He shed teardrops larger than pearls, and they were like a necklace on His chest.
7. Seeing her son so full of sorrow, Shachi, astonished, said together with the chaste wives: "My child³, why do You Yourself, at an auspicious rite, shed this inauspicious water from Your eyes?"
8. Having drunk in His mother's words, He, His face darkened by sighs at the memory of His father, stood by her and replied in a voice as deep as the thunder of a fresh rain-cloud:
9. "Mother, have I no wealth and no people, that today you spoke like a helpless woman, as though we had no one to lean on — because, you think, My father has gone and is seen no more?"

10. You yourself saw how, three times over, brahmanas and good people were given vessels full of choice betel nuts and perfumes of unrivalled quality, enough to anoint the whole body.
11. And how generously it was spent on other worthy people — you know that: on each as much as he wished. I have the power to do deeds beyond mortals, and yet I follow the ways of the world.
12. I may have lost My father, but My power is fathomless; even so, My mother's words wound Me." Hearing what He said, His mother calmed Him with sweet words.
13. And Sri Gaurachandra — the one friend of the world, charming to women, beautiful in His smile — was adorned with cosmetics, pairs of garments, jewels and priceless garlands,
14. and with unflagging faith anointed with sandal and the perfumes of choice aguru: this was done by the sons of the brahmanas, who had come at that auspicious hour to Him, the bull among men.
15. At that same hour the excellent Vallabha Mishra, having completed the rites for the ancestors and the gods, adorned with ornaments his daughter, fair as the finest gold.
16. Then he sent the most worthy brahmanas to bring the bridegroom. They came and said with blessings: "For good fortune, set out quickly, to the chanting of the Sama Veda!"
17. And Hari Himself, in a palanquin, with the good people sent by the best of brahmanas, amid cries of "Victory!" and rows of blazing lamps, set out for the Mishra's house — as Shiva once went to the golden peak⁴.
18. The Mishra came out to meet Him, himself led Him into his house and honoured Him as bridegroom: with water for His feet and the rest, with the finest perfumes, garments and garlands, and with incense of choice aguru.
19. The bridegroom shone like the full moon: His smiling face outshone Kama, and His slender body, pure and bright as Sumeru, gleamed with the lustre of molten gold.
20. His arms glittered with armlets, bracelets and rings, His palms were lovely as lotuses — and Hari, who grants the desires of all who take shelter of Him, at once became like a mighty wish-fulfilling tree.
21. Vallabha brought his daughter, beautifully adorned and radiant as the moon — her radiance dispelled all darkness — and duly gave her at the feet of the Teacher of the world. And then the beauty of the two shone forth.
22. Their moon-like faces, blazing with beauty as if in contest, were like the moon with Rohini⁵; they heightened each other's loveliness and, like Hara and Parvati, showered each other with handfuls of flowers.
23. When the Lord of Kamala had taken His seat, Lakshmi too sat down there shyly. Then the pure Vallabha, versed in the rites, came forward and sat before them to give away his daughter according to rule.
24. By offering water to His lotus feet Prajapati once obtained the power to create the world⁶; and to those very feet, whose shining nails dispel the darkness, Vallabha offered water for washing.
25. To Him to whom great Indra yielded his royal throne — a jewelled lion-seat spread with a rug⁷ — to Him, clad in the finest yellow garments, Vallabha, drinking Him in with his eyes, offered a fine silken seat.
26. Having performed in due order and according to rule the rites beginning with the offering of arghya — the hair on his body bristling with joy — the grateful Vallabha formally gave away his lotus-eyed daughter, placing her hand in Hari's.

27. When the great and auspicious festival was over, the almighty Vishvambhara, who relieves the Earth of her affliction⁸, took Lakshmi and, hailed by the people, went home in a palanquin.

Thus ends the tenth sarga, "The Wedding" (Vaivahika), of the first prakrama of the great poem "Sri Krishna-chaitanya-charitamrita."

1. The nandimukha shraddha is a rite honouring the ancestors, performed before a joyful event such as a wedding.
 2. That is, the ulu-dhvani, the joyful ululation of women customary at Bengali festivals.
 3. Literally "father," an affectionate way of addressing a son in Bengal.
 4. A comparison with Shiva's wedding procession to the house of Himavat, the father of Parvati (cf. v. 22).
 5. Rohini is the constellation who is the favourite wife of the Moon god.
 6. Prajapati is Brahma: he was able to create the world by the grace of the Lord, whom he worshipped.
 7. Indra (Mahendra), king of the gods, honours the Lord as his master.
 8. A play on words: Vishvambhara ("He who sustains the universe") relieves the affliction of Vishvabhara ("the All-bearing," the Earth).
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Prakrama 1, Sarga 11. The Festival of Sri Lakshmi's Departure

Lakshmi enters Shachi's house; the Lord's journey to East Bengal and the people's wonder; His stay on the bank of the Padmavati; Lakshmi's service to her mother-in-law; the snakebite and Lakshmi's departure in the waters of the Ganga

1. Then Shachi, together with the wives of the brahmanas, held a great festival and led her daughter-in-law, with her husband, into her house.
2. To the brahmanas she gave food, perfumes and garlands with devotion, and to others — the chief craftsmen and the dancers — she gave money.
3. And the Lord lived happily in that auspicious house with His family, shining like the moon among the stars in a clear sky.
4. At a mere glance from Lakshmi and Narayana all blessings came of themselves to the house of Sri Shachi — as if to proclaim their own good fortune.
5. Once settled in household life, He set out for the east with good companions to earn wealth, purifying those lands as He went.
6. Whatever land the Victorious One came to, He whose face was like the full moon, everywhere the people who lived there were filled with joy at the sight of Him.
7. Gazing at His face, they could never reach the farther shore of the ocean of satisfaction¹. And the women said: "Whose son is He, whose very sight purifies?"
8. By what merit did His mother bear in her womb this best of men, who surpasses Kandarpa? His like has never been seen anywhere.
9. Which girl, having long worshipped Shankara², has become His wife? He is Narayana, and she, without a doubt, is Lakshmi herself."
10. Hearing such words from the people everywhere, Hari went on His way, increasing their love with the moist glance of His eyes, which reached to His ears.
11. He came to the bank of the river Padmavati³, bathed according to rule and stayed there, worshipped by saintly people full of faith.
12. And that great river, the swift Padmavati with her broad sandbanks, became as purifying as the Ganga.

13. She was adorned with crocodiles, makaras⁴ and fish darting like lightning, and her broad banks were graced with the dwellings of the virtuous.
14. Her waters, cleansed by Vishvambhara's bath, take away sin, and she, the auspicious one, became the greatest of holy places. Dwelling on her bank, Hari
15. gave delight to the eyes of great and virtuous souls; and the Slayer of Madhu⁵, eager to see the saintly, rejoiced exceedingly.
16. So the merciful Master, the Almighty, who delighted in the taste of learning, spent several months there teaching all the brahmanas.
17. Meanwhile the blessed Lakshmi, whose husband was her very life and who was faithful to her vows, served Shachi by massaging her feet and in many other ways.
18. In the shrine of the deities she plastered and swept the floor, drew svastikas and other auspicious signs, and offered incense, lamps and the rest, food offerings and carefully made garlands.
19. Shachi was so pleased with her service, her speech, her good nature and her deeds that for a long time she felt her happiness complete.
20. Her hair bristled with tenderness for her son's matchless wife; out of love she cherished her like a daughter — just as she did her own son.
21. So she lived in the house; but in time, by the will of fate, a snake came and bit her on the sole of her foot. Seeing Lakshmi (so), Shachi,
22. seized with great fear, sent word about her daughter-in-law to the healers of snake poison, summoned them, and strove to draw out the poison.
23. But for all the many mantras Shachi tried, the poison did not leave. Then, deeming it the work of Time, she carefully brought her
24. into the waters of Jahnu's daughter⁶, adorned her daughter-in-law with a garland of tulasi and, together with the other women, sang the kirtana of Hari.
25. And when the clear sky had filled with the chariots of the Gandharvas, and Brahma and the other gods with the perfected yogis were singing an auspicious song,
26. Mahalakshmi, the mother of the world, remembering the lotus feet of Krishna, gave up her body in the heavenly river to go to her Lord.
27. And she went to her own beautiful abode, unattainable for Indra and the other gods, the very form of all that is auspicious —
28. Lakshmi, endowed with supreme splendour — to the abode revered by the worlds.

Thus ends the eleventh sarga, "The Festival of Sri Lakshmi's Departure" (Shri-lakshmi-vijaya-utsava)⁷, of the first prakrama of the great poem "Sri Krishna-chaitanya-charitamrita."

1. That is, they could never look at Him enough.
2. Girls worship Shiva (Shankara) to obtain a worthy husband.
3. The Padmavati (Padma) is the main branch of the Ganga in East Bengal.
4. The makara is a mythical water creature, the mount of Varuna and of the Ganga.
5. Madhu is a demon slain by Vishnu; "Slayer of Madhu" (Madhuha) is a name of the Lord.
6. Jahnu's daughter (Jahnavi) is the Ganga.
7. Vijaya here means "departure" (as in the Bengali usage for the passing of saints).

Prakrama 1, Sarga 12. The Consolation of Shachi; Lakshmi's Departure to Heaven

Shachi's lament for her daughter-in-law; the Lord's return from East Bengal; Shachi tells Him what has happened; the Lord consoles His mother with the story of an apsara cursed by Indra

1. Then Shachi grievously lamented for her daughter-in-law, who had been devoted to dharma, and the streams of tears flowing from her eyes bathed her breast.
2. She said: "Lowest of serpents! What is this wicked deed you have done? Why did you not bite me with your terrible fangs, and spare my daughter-in-law?"
3. My righteous son entrusted his wife with serving me, and went away, surrounded by his students, to earn wealth and grain for me.
4. How shall I, bereft of my daughter-in-law, now look upon my son's face?" Having lamented thus bitterly, overcome with grief, she left (the body of) her noble daughter-in-law and gave instructions:
5. "Perform the holy rite befitting our family." And a kinsman then performed it. And Shachi went home, shedding copious tears from eyes restless with weeping.
6. Soon her relatives and friends consoled her, and for a long time she remained as if at peace: she remembered her son's face, and her mouth was full of the name of Krishna.
7. Some days later the Supreme Lord joyfully brought home what the great saints had offered Him — silver, gold and cloth.
8. Seeing that her son had returned, radiant as the full moon, Shachi was not very glad at heart: she went to Him carrying in her heart the great pain of losing her daughter-in-law.
9. The lotus-eyed Lord, seeing Shachi, fell at her feet and placed the dust of her feet on His head; and when He looked at His mother's face, all clouded over, He was greatly surprised.
10. The Sinless One presented her with all the wealth He had gained and said, His words sprinkled with the nectar of a smile: "Tell Me, mother, why is your face so joyless today? How is your daughter-in-law?"
11. Gladdened by these nectar-like words, Shachi, in a voice that failed at the memory of her excellent daughter-in-law, told Him from her heart the whole story, while drops rolled from her lotus eyes.
12. At once His eyes grew moist and His body was filled with both grief and joy¹. Having heard these words, Madhusudana answered His mother, looking at her with eyes moist with compassion.
13. Concealing everything with words strong to hide His own self, the Lord of the world said: "Listen to how this apsara, a heavenly maiden, recently came down to earth.
14. Once, in the assembly of Maghavan², the moon-faced apsara by the will of fate faltered for a moment in her dance step. Seeing this and having considered it, the lord of the gods cursed her: 'Become the daughter of a man!'
15. Then she fell at his feet, and he said to her: 'Become the wife of the Lord of all, O lovely one! Having known the radiant feet of Hari, which even the gods can hardly attain, you will come back here again —
16. ah, you will return! Go, most lovely one!' The words of the lord of the gods filled her with joy. And now, in the waters of the river of the gods, she has cast off the sin born of the curse of the lord of the gods, and has gone.
17. Or else it was the Mistress of the world herself, in the form of Lakshmi, who went to the lotus feet of her Lord³. So enough of grief: what must be comes to pass — the whole world is wrought by Time."

18. Hearing these words of her moon-faced son, Shachi gave up her grief. Thus did Hari, having taken on a human nature, conceal His manifest glory.
19. And it is no wonder at all that Bhagavan Himself told a story of the gods — He by the power of whose might the Grandsire creates and Ishvara destroys the three worlds⁴.

Thus ends the twelfth sarga, "The Removal of Sri Shachi's Grief; Lakshmi's Departure to Heaven" (Shri-shachi-shoka-apanodana, Lakshmi-svarga-gamana), of the first prakrama of the great poem "Sri Krishna-chaitanya-charitamrita."

1. The beginning of the verse is corrupt in all witnesses; the translation is conjectural.
2. Maghavan is Indra, king of the gods.
3. First the Lord tells the "concealing" story of the apsara (v. 13), and then hints at the truth: His consort is Lakshmi herself.
4. The Grandsire is Brahma; Ishvara is Shiva.